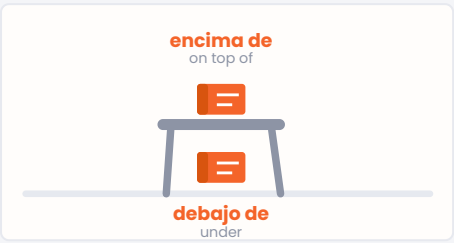
¿DÓNDE ESTÁ?
WHERE THINGS ARE

grey is the thing you are talking about — orange is what you are placing

1. Twelve pictures, twelve sentences each word carries its English — the opposite is drawn alongside, and the caption is a card you already have



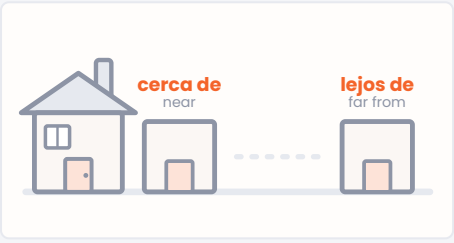
El libro está encima de la mesa.
The book is on the table.



Las llaves están dentro del bolso.
The keys are inside the bag.



El coche está delante de la casa.
The car is in front of the house.



El banco está cerca de mi casa.
The bank is near my house.



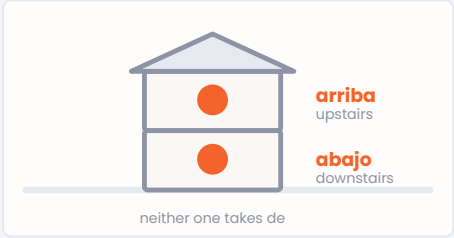
a la izquierda / a la derecha de
to the left of / to the right of



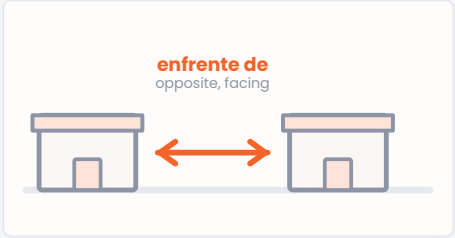
La farmacia está al lado del banco.
The pharmacy is next to the bank.



Mi casa está entre el parque y la iglesia.
My house is between the park and the church.



El baño está abajo.
The bathroom is downstairs.



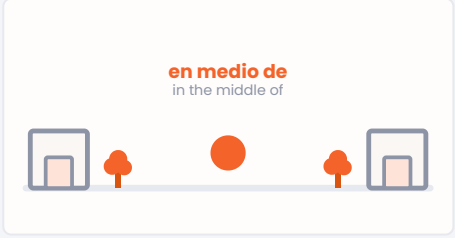
El supermercado está enfrente del colegio.
The supermarket is opposite the school.



en la mesa · en el bolso
on the table · in the bag

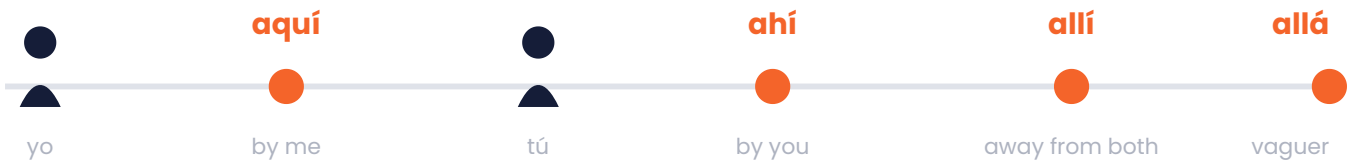


El baño está al final del pasillo.
The bathroom is at the end of the corridor.



en medio de la plaza
in the middle of the square

2. aquí · ahí · allí · allá English has two words for this; Spanish has four, and they measure distance from the speaker



They line up with **este · ese · aquel**: *este libro, aquí · ese libro, ahí · aquel libro, allí*. Learn them as pairs and you get both sets for the price of one.

3. They nearly all need de and the two that don't are the ones you will get wrong

encima de · debajo de · dentro de · fuera de
delante de · detrás de · al lado de
cerca de · lejos de · enfrente de · alrededor de
and *de + el* contracts: al lado del banco, lejos del centro

entre la mesa y la silla — no *de*, and it takes *y*
sobre la mesa — no *de* · same as *encima de*
junto a la ventana — this one takes *a*, not *de*
en la mesa — the everyday catch-all

The *de* only appears when something follows. *El banco está cerca.* — nothing after it, so no *de*. *El banco está cerca de mi casa.* — a noun follows, so the *de* comes back. Same for *dentro*, *delante*, *detrás*, *encima*.

All of these take **estar**, never *ser* — *el libro **está** encima de la mesa*. The one exception is an event: *la fiesta **es** en mi casa*. See **poster-ser-estar**, section 5.